www.tntextbooks.in

Jill:

Er—thank you. Aunt Jane. It's very nice of you. (awkwardly)

Aunt Jane:

There! Now I must be going. (patting her arm)

Jack: I'll see you to the bus, anyway.

Jill:

Good-bye, Aunt Jane—and thanks so much for the present.

Aunt Jane:

Good-bye, my dear. (She and Jack go out. Jill looks at the cheque and (kissing her) exclaims 'Ten pounds!' Then she hurries to the table, addresses an envelope, **endorses** the cheque and slips it inside with a bill which she takes from the bag and seals the envelope. Then she rings the bell. In a moment the NURSE comes in with the baby in her arms.)

Jill:

Oh, nurse. I want you to run and post this for me. I'll look after baby while you're gone.

Nurse:

Certainly, madam. (She hands the baby to Jill, takes the letter, and goes.)

Jack:

Well, she's gone! What a **tartar**! Still, she did leave us a bit on account—how much was it?

Jill: Ten pounds.

Jack: Phew! That's great! We can pay off the next two months on the car with (with a whistle) that.

Jill: I—I'm afraid we can't—

Jack: Why ever not?

Jill:

You see, I—I've already sent it off for something else. Nurse has just gone to post it.

Jack:

Well that's all right. Who have you sent it to?

Jill: Dr. Martin.

Jack:

Dr Martin! What on earth **possessed** you to do that?

Jill (nearly in tears):

There! Now you're going to be angry with me.

Jack:

I'm not angry! But why waste good money on the doctor? Doctors don't expect to get paid anyway.

Jill (sobbing a little):

Bu—but you don't understand —

Jack: Understand what?

Jill:

Why; just one more installment and BABY'S REALLY OURS!

(She is holding out the infant, a little pathetically, as we black out.)

Cedric Mount